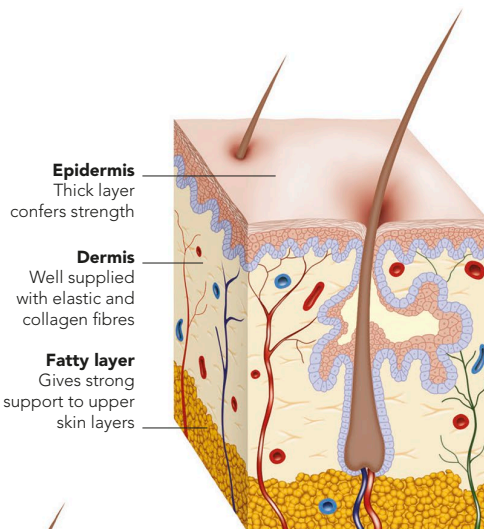


AGEING

THE BRAIN, MUSCLES, JOINTS, EYES, AND OTHER ORGANS ALL DECLINE WITH AGE, BUT CHANGES ARE USUALLY SMALL UNTIL AFTER THE AGE OF 60. GENETICS AND LIFESTYLE ARE MAJOR CONTRIBUTORS TO A PERSON'S LIFESPAN.

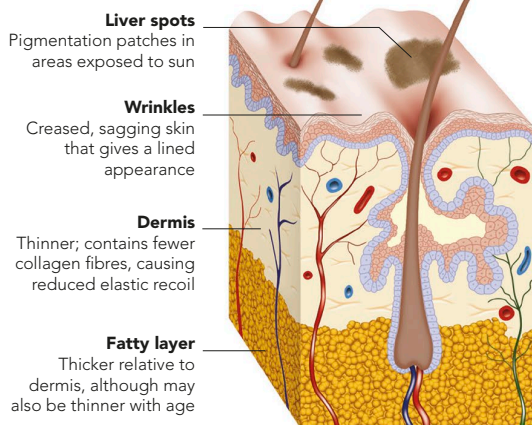
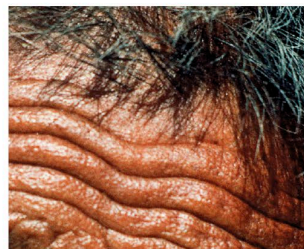
CELLULAR DETERIORATION

Cells divide a fixed number of times and then stop functioning properly. Connective tissue becomes increasingly stiff, making the organs, blood vessels, and airways more rigid. Changes in cell membranes impede the delivery of oxygen and nutrients and the removal of carbon dioxide and wastes, causing an increase in pigments and fatty substances inside cells. How quickly a person's cells deteriorate, and therefore how long he or she lives, is a balance between how fast things go wrong with cells and how efficiently the body functions to prevent damage from building up.



YOUNG SKIN

A thick top layer, many elastic and collagen fibres in the deeper layers, good layers of supporting fat, and plenty of sebaceous glands producing oil all help to maintain the smoothness and suppleness of young skin.



OLDER SKIN

A thinner outer layer, and fewer elastic fibres and collagen in the deeper layers, result in skin that appears loose, with deeper creases and wrinkles.

AGEING GRACEFULLY

Skin wrinkling is one of the most visible signs of ageing. Creased and sagging skin, seen as wrinkles, can be predetermined by genes.